

Say NO to Fabricated Citations: A Multi-Layered Conceptual Framework

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Summary

With Generative AI adoption in writing, presence of fabricated references in students' dissertations, reports, and scientific papers are witnessed. This work presents a fabrication severity stack to classify these hallucinations, loosely bonded with detection complexity. As result, a robust reference verification can be a fundamental requirement for both academic assessment and peer review. Furthermore, the research findings of this work demonstrate that effective detection does not necessitate expensive, proprietary software; rather, it can be achieved through the strategic application of mainstream tools and structured heuristics.

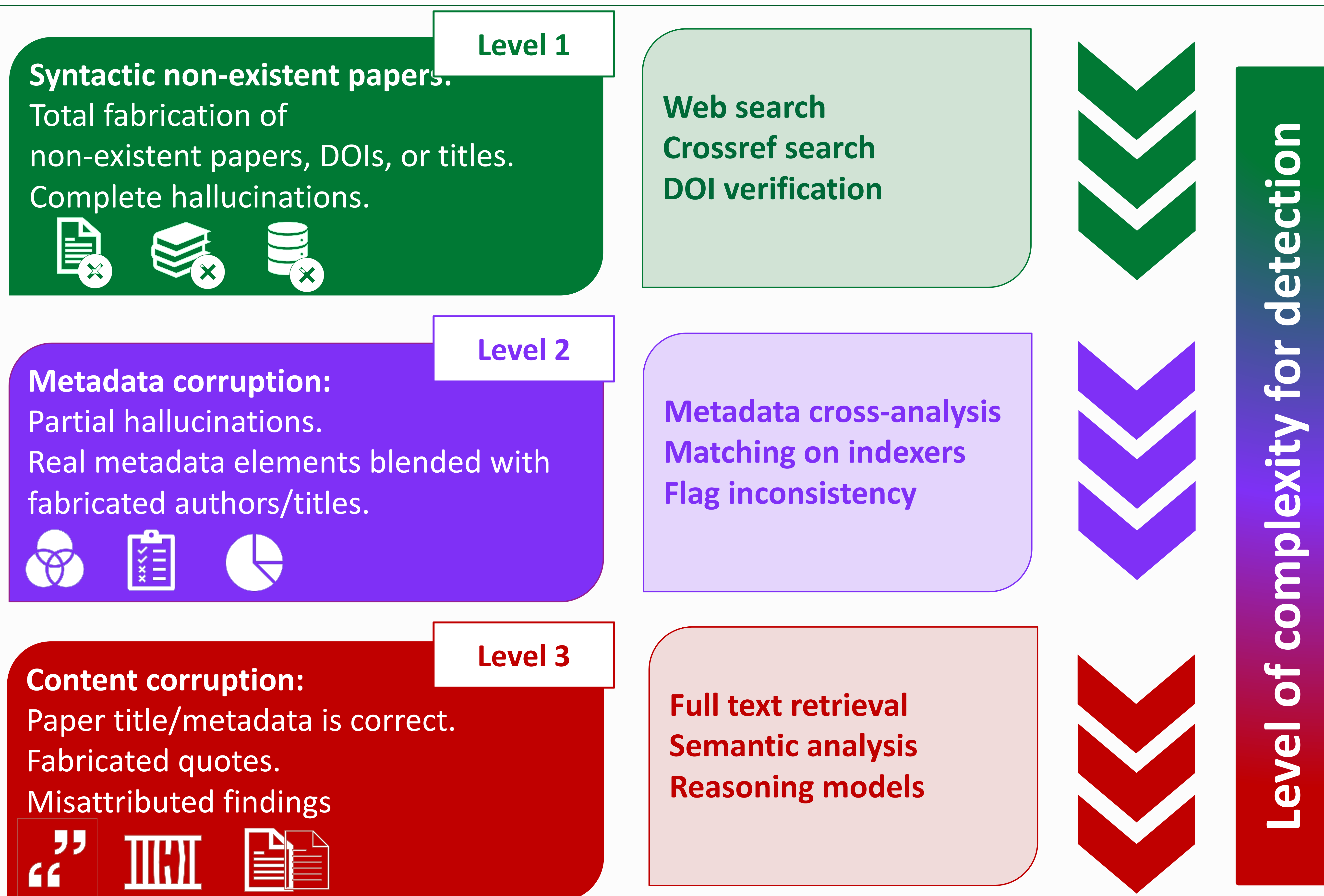


Figure 1. Fabrication Severity Stack



Figure 2. A Heuristics-based workflow for verification of references

References

1. Naddaf, M. and Quill, E., 2026. The growing problem of hallucinated citations. Nature, 652, pp.26-29.
2. Topaz, M., Roguin, N., Gupta, P., Zhang, Z. and Peltonen, L.M., 2026. Fabricated citations: an audit across 2· 5 million biomedical papers. The Lancet, 407(10541), pp.1779-1781.

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<https://github.com/hazratali/citefake>

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